



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS AND BACHELOR OF
EDUCATION

ARE 227/272: THEORY AND METHOD IN THE STUDY OF RELIGION

1ST SEMESTER 2024/2025

TIME: 2 HOURS

INSTRUCTIONS: ANSWER THREE QUESTIONS ATLEAST ONE FROM EACH QUESTION.

SECTION I

QUESTION ONE

- With examples, explain why religion is a complex phenomenon to define.
- What are the features of a good definition of religion in your view?

QUESTION TWO

With suitable examples, explain the following distinguishing marks of religion.

- Sacred and profane
- Myth and doctrines
- Symbols and signs
- Rituals and worship

QUESTION THREE

EITHER

- Discuss why ^{Fear}religion is considered by some scholars as the parent of religion

OR

- Show why magic is argued to be the first form of religion.

SECTION II

QUESTION FOUR

- What is the scientific study of religion?
- Describe the historical background of the scientific study in religion.

QUESTION FIVE

Discuss the contribution of any ONE of the following in the study of religion:

- i) William James
- ii) Edmund Husserl
- iii) Max Muller

QUESTION SIX

EITHER

- a) Examine the views of any ONE postmodern scholar of religion you have studied.

OR

- b) Discuss how the internet has revolutionized religion.

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EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS AND
BACHELOR OF EDUCATION (ARTS)

ARE 227/272: THEORY AND METHOD IN THE STUDY OF RELIGION

1ST SEMESTER 2023/2024

TIME: 2 HOURS

INSTRUCTIONS:

ANSWER THREE QUESTIONS, AT LEAST ONE FROM EACH SECTION

SECTION I

1. (a) Give ONE definition of religion by a scholar you have studied and show why it is not comprehensive.
(b) What are the characteristics of a good definition of religion?

✓ 2. With examples discuss the following concepts as used in the study of religion.

- (i) Symbol and sign
- (ii) Sacred and profane
- (iii) Myth, doctrine and dogma
- (iv) Ritual, rite and worship

3. Discuss how different scholars have associated the origin of religion with any TWO of the following concepts.

- (a) Magic
- (b) Fear
- (c) Wish fulfillment

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SECTION II

4. (a) Explain in details what is the scientific study of religion
(b) Show the contribution of any ONE of the following scholars in the scientific study of religion:

INVOLVEMENT IN EXAMINATION IRREGULARITY SHALL LEAD TO DISCONTINUATION

- (i) Max Muller
- (ii) Edmund Husserl
- (iii) William James

15. (a) what is feminism?
(b) discuss the views of any ONE postmodern feminist scholar you studied on religion.
16. Discuss how internet technology has revolutionized religious practices in society.

1. She argue that Christianity was a set of myth.
2. She argue that women were part of planet earth.
3. She is considered as a feminist.

is the belief that men and female should have equal opportunity.

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BACHELOR OF EDUCATION (ARTS)**

ARE 227/272: THEORY AND METHOD IN THE STUDY OF RELIGION

1ST SEMESTER 2023/2024

TIME: 2 HOURS

INSTRUCTIONS:

ANSWER THREE QUESTIONS, AT LEAST ONE FROM EACH SECTION

SECTION I

1. (a) Give ONE definition of religion by a scholar you have studied and show why it is not comprehensive.
(b) What are the characteristics of a good definition of religion?
2. With examples discuss the following concepts as used in the study of religion.
 - (i) Symbol and sign
 - (ii) Sacred and profane
 - (iii) Myth, doctrine and dogma
 - (iv) Ritual, rite and worship
3. Discuss how different scholars have associated the origin of religion with any TWO of the following concepts.
 - (a) Magic
 - (b) Fear
 - (c) Wish fulfillment

SECTION II

4. (a) Explain in details what is the scientific study of religion
(b) Show the contribution of any ONE of the following scholars in the scientific study of religion:

- (i) Max Muller
- (ii) Edmund Husserl
- (iii) William James

5. (a) what is feminism?

(b) discuss the views of any ONE postmodern feminist scholar you studied on religion.

6. Discuss how internet technology has revolutionized religious practices in society.

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